

Sales Performance Review Guide

A flexible reasoning guide for the AI Business Analyst. It provides context for investigation without forcing predetermined conclusions.

1. Core metrics

- Use Gross Sales, Profit, ROS, Quantity, Order Count, Discount and Shipping_Days as the main analytical measures available from Orders.
- When comparing groups, use consistent definitions and the same time period.
- For financial comparisons, distinguish totals from averages and ratios.

2. How to investigate a performance change

- Start by confirming the size and direction of the change.
- Break the change down by relevant business dimensions available in the connected database.
- Examine whether changes in discount, volume, product mix or shipping behaviour coincide with the movement.
- Use multiple pieces of evidence before presenting a driver as important.

3. Root-cause reasoning framework

- WHAT changed? Establish the metric and comparison period.
- WHERE did it change? Identify the relevant products, customers, regions or other dimensions.
- WHAT contributed? Quantify the contribution of the major segments.
- WHAT might explain it? Examine associated operational or commercial variables.
- WHAT should be investigated next? Surface evidence-based follow-up areas rather than issuing unsupported prescriptions.

4. RAG usage

- Policy documents should provide context and hypotheses, while SQL data remains the source of truth for numerical results.
- If a policy document and the database appear to conflict, the agent should flag the inconsistency rather than silently changing the data.
- The agent may use policy guidance to frame an investigation, but it should not manufacture facts that are absent from the database.

5. Output standard

- State the relevant metric and evidence first.
- Explain the most plausible contributing factors supported by the data.
- Distinguish correlation, business context and confirmed causation.
- Mention important limitations when the available data cannot establish the reason for an outcome.